Level 3 – Illusion
Casting Time: Action · Range: Self (30-foot Cone)
Components: V, S, M (a white feather or the heart of a hen) · Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute
Classes: Bard, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Each creature in a **30-foot Cone** must succeed on a **Wisdom saving throw** or drop whatever it is holding and have the **Frightened** condition for the duration.

While Frightened, a creature must take the **Dash** action and move away from you by the safest and shortest route on each of its turns, unless there is nowhere to move. If it ends its turn in a location where it has no line of sight to you, it can repeat the saving throw: on a success, the spell ends on it.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You project a 30-ft Cone.
2. Each creature makes a Wisdom save.
3. Failure: it drops what it holds and is Frightened.
4. It flees by Dash; it repeats the save if it ends its turn out of your sight.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say what a Frightened creature does if trapped, or how to treat creatures that can't see the caster. Fix: the DM announces those cases before the game.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe an icy shiver, pale faces, weapons falling from trembling hands.

Step 1 – Cast the Cone:

Action, Concentration. A 30-ft Cone from you.

Step 2 – Wisdom saves:

Each creature in the Cone makes a Wisdom save against your spell save DC.

Step 3 – Failure:

The creature drops what it holds and is Frightened: each turn, it Dashes and moves away from you.

Step 4 – New save:

If it ends its turn with no line of sight to you, it repeats the save; success: the spell ends on it.

Example: Sélène (DC 14) casts Fear on three goblins. Two fail: they drop their weapons and flee by Dash. Next turn, one ends out of her sight: it repeats the save and succeeds.

FEAR (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

⚠ Common questions:

How long does it last?
Concentration, up to 1 minute.

What does a Frightened creature do?
It Dashes and moves away from you each turn.

Can it attack?
It must use its action to Dash away.

How does it break free?
End its turn with no line of sight to you and succeed on a Wisdom save.

What area?
A 30-ft Cone.

Are allies hit?
Yes, any creature in the Cone.

Must I see the target?
No: any creature in the Cone.

⚠ Debate points and table options:
Table rule

Trapped or cornered
A Frightened creature with no exit can't flee.
Option: it stays put; or it cowers.

Dropped objects
It drops what it holds, with no picking up.
Option: it may pick up on its turn but isn't required.

Allies in the Cone
The Cone hits everyone. **Option**: no exceptions.

Line of sight
A wall or darkness breaks line of sight. **Option**: the DM rules based on visibility.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Fear and line of sight
The Frightened condition imposes Disadvantage only when you can see the source of fear: you can't have line of sight to what you can't see.

Concentration: range and sight
To keep concentrating, you don't need to stay in range or keep the spell in sight, unless the spell or another feature says so.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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